

MERIDIAN & ASSOCIATES LLP

Advisory | Assurance | Tax | Consulting

Team Capacity & Utilization Overview

Q1 2026 Resource Planning Report

CONFIDENTIAL

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Meridian & Associates LLP | New York | Chicago | San Francisco | London | Singapore

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1. Executive Summary

This report provides a summary of Meridian & Associates LLP's current workforce utilization rates, available capacity by practice area, and bench strength analysis. The data is intended to support RFP response teams in accurately representing the firm's ability to staff new engagements. Data is current as of February 28, 2026.

Overall firm utilization for Q4 FY2025 was 76.8%, within our target range of 75-80%. The firm has meaningful available capacity across all practice areas, with particular depth in Advisory/Consulting and Tax Services. Seasonal patterns in audit utilization (busy season January-April) are reflected in the practice-level data below.

2. Firm-Wide Utilization Summary (Q4 FY2025)

Firm-Wide Utilization Rate: 76.8%

Target Utilization Range: 75% - 80%

Total Chargeable Hours (Q4): 18,420,000 hours

Available Capacity Hours (Q4): 5,580,000 hours

Total Headcount: 68,420 professionals

Net Hiring (Q4): +1,240 professionals (1,840 hires, 600 departures)

3. Utilization by Practice Area

3.1 Audit & Assurance

Headcount: 22,140 professionals

Q4 Utilization: 72.4% (note: off-peak; Q1 utilization typically 88-92%)

Available Capacity (Q2-Q4 FY2026): Moderate -- approximately 4,200 FTEs available for new work

The Audit & Assurance practice follows a well-established seasonal cycle. January through April represents peak busy season with utilization rates of 88-92%. Post-busy season (May through December), utilization typically ranges from 68-75%, creating meaningful capacity for new engagements, particularly those with summer or fall start dates.

Capacity by Sub-Practice

- **Financial Statement Audit (SEC Registrants):** Limited availability Q1; moderate availability Q2-Q4 (est. 1,200 FTEs)
- **Financial Statement Audit (Private Companies):** Moderate availability year-round (est. 800 FTEs)
- **Government Audit:** Available -- 420 FTEs with CGFM/Yellow Book qualifications available for new engagements
- **Internal Audit & Co-Sourcing:** Available -- 640 FTEs, strong bench for new internal audit mandates
- **IT Audit & SOC Reporting:** Available -- 380 FTEs with CISA/CISSP credentials
- **Employee Benefit Plan Audit:** Seasonal (peak July-October); available November-June (est. 280 FTEs)

3.2 Tax Services

Headcount: 16,840 professionals

Q4 Utilization: 74.2% (note: between extension season and year-end planning)

Available Capacity (Q2-Q4 FY2026): Significant -- approximately 3,800 FTEs available

Tax Services experiences two peak periods: the spring filing season (February-April, utilization 85-90%) and the fall extension season (September-October, utilization 82-86%). Between peaks, meaningful capacity exists for tax planning, compliance onboarding, and advisory projects.

Capacity by Sub-Practice

- **Corporate Income Tax Compliance:** Moderate availability off-peak (est. 1,400 FTEs)
- **International Tax:** Available -- 620 FTEs including transfer pricing specialists
- **State & Local Tax (SALT):** Available -- 840 FTEs across all US regions
- **Indirect Tax (Sales/Use, VAT/GST):** Available -- 480 FTEs
- **Tax Technology & Transformation:** Available -- 320 FTEs with tax technology platform experience
- **Private Client / High Net Worth:** Limited -- near capacity, selective new client acceptance

3.3 Advisory & Consulting

Headcount: 24,280 professionals

Q4 Utilization: 78.6%

Available Capacity (FY2026): Strong -- approximately 5,200 FTEs available for new engagements

The Advisory & Consulting practice maintains relatively stable utilization throughout the year without significant seasonal variation. Current pipeline analysis indicates strong demand in digital transformation, cloud migration, and regulatory compliance, with available capacity across most sub-practices.

Capacity by Sub-Practice

- **Strategy & Operations:** Available -- 840 FTEs across all industries
- **Technology Consulting:** Available -- 1,420 FTEs (cloud, ERP, data & analytics)
- **Risk Advisory:** Available -- 680 FTEs (regulatory, operational, cyber risk)
- **Financial Advisory / M&A:** Moderate -- 420 FTEs available, pipeline dependent
- **Digital Transformation:** Available -- 780 FTEs (agile, product, UX/UI, DevOps)
- **Change Management & Org Design:** Available -- 340 FTEs
- **Cybersecurity Services:** Available -- 520 FTEs, growing practice with active hiring
- **Supply Chain & Operations:** Available -- 280 FTEs

3.4 Managed Services

Headcount: 5,160 professionals

Q4 Utilization: 84.2% (highest across firm)

Available Capacity: Limited -- selective capacity for new managed service contracts

Managed Services operates at consistently high utilization due to the recurring, contracted nature of the work. New managed service engagements typically require a 60-90 day ramp-up period for recruitment and onboarding of dedicated staff.

4. Bench Strength and Rapid Mobilization

Meridian maintains a structured approach to bench management and rapid team mobilization for new engagements:

Strategic Bench

Approximately 4,800 professionals (7% of total staff) are currently on the strategic bench -- between engagements and available for immediate deployment. Bench professionals remain productive through internal projects, training, and proposal support. Average time on bench is 3.2 weeks.

Rapid Mobilization Capabilities

- Small engagements (2-5 FTEs): Team assembled and on-site within 2 weeks
- Medium engagements (6-20 FTEs): Team assembled within 3-4 weeks
- Large engagements (21-50 FTEs): Team assembled within 4-6 weeks
- Major programs (50+ FTEs): Dedicated mobilization team, 6-8 weeks for full staffing

Mobilization timelines assume standard engagement parameters. Engagements requiring niche skills, specific certifications, or security clearances may require additional lead time.

5. Hiring and Growth Plan (FY2026)

Meridian's FY2026 hiring plan supports both replacement needs and strategic growth investments:

Total Planned Hires (FY2026): 8,400 professionals

Campus / Entry Level: 3,200 (38% of hires)

Experienced Hires: 4,400 (52% of hires)

Lateral Partner / MD Hires: 120 (1.5% of hires)

Contingent / Contract: 680 (8.5% of hires)

Strategic Growth Areas

- Cybersecurity Services: +320 net new hires (25% practice growth)
- Cloud & Data Engineering: +280 net new hires (18% practice growth)
- AI/ML Advisory: +180 net new hires (new sub-practice launch)
- ESG Assurance & Advisory: +140 net new hires (regulatory demand driven)

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- Healthcare IT Advisory: +120 net new hires (EHR modernization demand)

~~6. Subcontractor and Alliance Partner Capacity~~

In addition to internal resources, Meridian maintains relationships with vetted subcontractor firms and technology alliance partners that can augment capacity for large or specialized engagements:

- **Preferred Subcontractor Network:** 14 pre-qualified firms with master subcontract agreements, providing access to approximately 8,000 additional professionals
- **Offshore Delivery Centers:** Meridian-owned centers in Bangalore (2,400 staff), Hyderabad (1,800 staff), and Manila (1,200 staff) provide cost-effective delivery for analytics, testing, and managed services
- **Technology Alliance Partners:** Strategic partnerships with Microsoft, AWS, Google Cloud, SAP, Oracle, Workday, ServiceNow, and Salesforce provide access to partner resources and co-delivery capabilities
- **Academic Partnerships:** Relationships with 45 universities for specialized research, internship pipelines, and faculty consulting arrangements

~~7. Contact for Resource Inquiries~~

For specific resource availability inquiries related to an RFP response or new engagement opportunity, please contact:

Rachel Morrison
Chief Talent Officer
Meridian & Associates LLP
Email: r.morrison@meridian-llp.com
Phone: (212) 555-0234

Resource requests for specific RFP proposals should be submitted through the Pursuit Resource Request (PRR) system in Meridian WorkStream, with a minimum 10-business-day lead time for team identification and availability confirmation.